

Preliminary tax and filing deadlines memo

AIBN CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS · MEMO · JULY 2026

An owner-managed Irish company and its directors have to hit two separate calendars: the company's corporation tax and VAT dates, which run off the accounting period, and the director's own income tax dates, which run off the calendar year. The three dates that matter most in the second half of 2026 are Wednesday 18 November 2026 for the director's Form 11 and preliminary income tax through ROS, 23 November 2026 for preliminary corporation tax where the company has a 31 December year end, and 15 December 2026 for capital gains tax on disposals made between January and November. Late payment costs interest of roughly 8 to 10 per cent a year, and a late return costs a surcharge of 5 or 10 per cent of the liability on top of that, even where the tax itself was paid in full and on time.

Income tax: the Form 11 deadline and the ROS extension

If you control, directly or indirectly, more than 15 per cent of the share capital of your company, you are a proprietary director. Revenue treats a proprietary director as a chargeable person, which means you must file a Form 11 every year, even where all of your income has already been taxed under PAYE and there is nothing further to pay.

Three separate obligations fall due on the same date. You file the Form 11 for the previous year, you pay the balance of tax for that year, and you pay preliminary tax for the current year. For the 2025 tax year, that date is 31 October 2026, which falls on a Saturday.

Revenue allows a later date if you both file the return and make the payment through ROS. For 2026 the extended date is Wednesday 18 November 2026. The extension is conditional and Revenue applies it strictly. If you file through ROS but pay by another method, or pay through ROS but file on paper, the extension does not apply and your deadline reverts to 31 October 2026.

The same extended date covers capital acquisitions tax returns and payments where the valuation date of a gift or inheritance falls between 1 September 2025 and 31 August 2026. This matters where a director has received shares or property from a family member during that window.

- Standard pay and file date for the 2025 Form 11: Saturday 31 October 2026.
- ROS extended date for 2026: Wednesday 18 November 2026.
- You must both pay and file on ROS to get the extension. Doing only one of the two loses it entirely.
- A proprietary director holds more than 15 per cent of the share capital and must file a Form 11 regardless of PAYE deductions.

Preliminary income tax: how much to pay and what an underpayment costs

Preliminary tax is your own estimate of the income tax, PRSI and USC you will owe for the current year, paid before the year has finished. It falls due on the same date as the balance for the previous year, so the November ROS date carries two payments at once.

You may pay the lowest of three amounts: 90 per cent of your final liability for the current year, 100 per cent of your liability for the previous year, or 105 per cent of your liability for the year before that. The 105 per cent option is open only if you pay by monthly direct debit, and it is not available if your liability for that earlier year was nil.

In practice the 100 per cent option is the safe choice, because the figure is already known and cannot be got wrong. The 90 per cent option preserves cash where profits are falling, but it is an estimate, and if the estimate falls short you pay interest on the shortfall as though the money had been late from the original due date.

Two moving parts make a 90 per cent estimate harder than usual for 2026. Self-employed PRSI is 4.2 per cent up to 30 September 2026 and rises to 4.35 per cent from 1 October 2026, so a full-year estimate has to blend the two rates. The USC 2 per cent band also widened for 2026, from EUR 27,382 to EUR 28,700, with the 3 per cent band running to EUR 70,044 as before. Income tax rates, bands and the main personal credits were left unchanged by Budget 2026.

Where preliminary tax is short, Revenue charges interest at 0.0219 per cent for each day or part of a day, running from the original due date. That is close to 8 per cent a year. Interest applies even where the return itself was filed on time, because it attaches to the payment rather than the filing.

- Option 1: 90 per cent of the current year liability.
- Option 2: 100 per cent of the prior year liability. This is the safe harbour, because the number is already fixed.
- Option 3: 105 per cent of the pre-preceding year liability, available only to direct debit payers and not where that year was nil.
- Interest on a shortfall: 0.0219 per cent per day, roughly 8 per cent a year, from the original due date.

Corporation tax: the CT1 return and preliminary payments

The company's CT1 return is due nine months after the end of the accounting period. Where the accounting period ends before the 21st day of a month, the return is due on the corresponding day of the ninth month afterwards. Where it ends on or after the 21st, the return is due by the 21st day of the ninth month. If the company both files and pays through ROS, that 21st becomes the 23rd. A company with a 31 December 2025 year end therefore files by 21 September 2026, or by 23 September 2026 using ROS.

Preliminary corporation tax depends on whether the company counts as small or large. A small company is one whose corporation tax liability for the previous accounting period was not above EUR

200,000. Anything above that figure makes the company large for this purpose, and the payment pattern changes completely.

A small company makes a single payment. It is due 31 days before the end of the accounting period, and no later than the 23rd of that month. For a company with a 31 December 2026 year end, that produces a due date of 23 November 2026. The company pays either 90 per cent of the liability for the current period or 100 per cent of the liability for the previous period, whichever it prefers.

A large company pays in two instalments. The first is due on the 23rd of the sixth month of the accounting period and is either 45 per cent of the current period liability or 50 per cent of the previous period liability. The second is due on the 23rd of the eleventh month and brings the total up to 90 per cent of the final liability. Where the accounting period is shorter than seven months, a large company pays 90 per cent in one instalment by the 23rd of the sixth month.

A new company does not have to pay preliminary tax for its first accounting period where its corporation tax for that period comes in below EUR 200,000. It pays the full amount when it files the CT1 instead, which is a useful cash flow point for a company in its first trading year.

Corporation tax is 12.5 per cent on trading profits and 25 per cent on passive income such as rental and investment income. Where the company claims the research and development credit, Budget 2026 increased the rate from 30 per cent to 35 per cent and raised the amount payable in year one from EUR 75,000 to EUR 87,500.

One qualification applies to every preliminary corporation tax date in this section. The statutory date is the 21st of the relevant month, extended to the 23rd only where the payment is made electronically through ROS. Most companies pay electronically and so work to the 23rd, but a company outside mandatory e-filing that pays on the 23rd is two days late and exposed to interest.

- CT1 due nine months after the accounting period end, by the 21st of that month, extended to the 23rd where the company both files and pays on ROS.
- Small company test: corporation tax liability of EUR 200,000 or less in the previous accounting period.
- Small company preliminary tax: one payment, 31 days before the period end and no later than the 23rd of that month, at 90 per cent of the current period or 100 per cent of the prior period.
- Large company: 45 per cent of current or 50 per cent of prior by the 23rd of month six, then a top up to 90 per cent by the 23rd of month eleven.
- Accounting period under seven months: a large company pays 90 per cent in a single instalment, due on the earlier of 31 days before the end of the accounting period, or the 21st of the month in which that day falls (23rd for electronic payments).
- First accounting period with corporation tax under EUR 200,000: no preliminary tax required.

VAT returns, the Return of Trading Details, and payroll reporting

The default VAT period is two months, running from the first day of January, March, May, July,

September and November. The VAT 3 return and the payment are due by the 19th of the month after the period ends, or by the 23rd where you both file and pay through ROS.

Less frequent filing is available with the agreement of the Collector-General. Where your annual VAT liability is between EUR 3,001 and EUR 14,400 you can move to four-monthly returns. Where it is between EUR 1 and EUR 3,000 you can move to six-monthly returns. Monthly filing is normally used by businesses that are consistently in a repayment position and want their refunds sooner.

Once a year you must also file a Return of Trading Details. This is a statistical return setting out total purchases and sales for the year broken down by VAT rate. It carries no payment, which is exactly why it is so often overlooked, but Revenue can withhold tax clearance and hold up VAT repayments while it remains outstanding. It is due by the 23rd of the month following the end of the accounting period it covers.

Payroll reporting is real time. You must send Revenue a payroll submission on or before the day you pay the employee, not after the event. Revenue then builds a monthly statement by the 5th of the following month. If you neither accept nor amend it, that statement automatically becomes your return on the 14th. Payment of the PAYE, PRSI, USC and LPT deducted is due by the 14th of the following month, or the 23rd where you file and pay through ROS. Quarterly and annual remitters still receive a monthly statement, but their payment dates follow their own remittance frequency.

The enhanced reporting requirements sit alongside normal payroll. Where you give an employee or director a benefit under the small benefit exemption, pay the remote working daily allowance, or reimburse travel and subsistence, those details must be reported through ROS on or before the date of payment.

Two points on interest are worth flagging. First, the rate on late VAT and late payroll taxes is 0.0274 per cent per day, close to 10 per cent a year, which is materially higher than the rate on income tax and corporation tax. Second, the ROS date of the 23rd is a concession rather than a new statutory date. If you do not both file and pay by the 23rd, Revenue calculates interest from the original due date plus one day, so on a bi-monthly VAT period the interest clock starts on the 20th rather than the 24th.

- Default VAT period: two months, starting 1 January, 1 March, 1 May, 1 July, 1 September and 1 November.
- VAT 3 due the 19th of the following month, extended to the 23rd for ROS pay and file.
- Four-monthly returns: annual VAT liability of EUR 3,001 to EUR 14,400. Six-monthly: EUR 1 to EUR 3,000.
- Return of Trading Details due by the 23rd of the month after the accounting period ends. No payment attaches, but tax clearance and repayments can be blocked.
- Payroll submission on or before every pay date. Monthly statement issued by the 5th, deemed a return on the 14th, paid by the 14th or the 23rd on ROS.

Capital gains tax: payment dates run ahead of the return

Capital gains tax is unusual in that the payment dates come well before the return date, and there are two of them in each year. Owner-managers selling shares, property or a business regularly get caught by this, because the instinct is to deal with everything at the Form 11 deadline.

For disposals made between 1 January and 30 November, the tax is due by 15 December of that same year. For disposals made during December, the tax is due by 31 January of the following year. The date for the main period is 15 December, not 1 December. On a disposal made in July 2026, for example, the tax has to be with Revenue by 15 December 2026, roughly eleven months before the return that reports it.

The return is a separate obligation. Chargeable gains are declared on the Form 11 by 31 October of the following year, or on a Form CG1 where the individual is not otherwise a chargeable person for income tax.

One trap deserves particular attention. Filing a Form 11 and leaving the chargeable gains panel blank counts as not having filed a capital gains tax return at all. If a gain later comes to light, the individual is treated as a non-filer for CGT and the late filing surcharge applies, even though the income tax return went in on time.

Capital gains tax is charged at 33 per cent, and the first EUR 1,270 of an individual's annual gains is exempt. For owner-managers planning an exit, Budget 2026 increased the lifetime limit for revised entrepreneur relief from EUR 1 million to EUR 1.5 million, applying to disposals of chargeable business assets made on or after 1 January 2026.

- Disposals 1 January to 30 November 2026: pay by 15 December 2026.
- Disposals 1 to 31 December 2026: pay by 31 January 2027.
- Return due 31 October of the following year, on the Form 11 or Form CG1.
- Rate 33 per cent, annual personal exemption EUR 1,270.
- Leaving the chargeable gains panel of the Form 11 blank is treated as failing to file a CGT return.

What late filing and late payment actually cost

Two separate charges apply, and they stack on top of each other. Interest attaches to late payment. The surcharge attaches to the late return. You can incur one without the other.

Interest on late payment runs at 0.0219 per cent per day for income tax, corporation tax, capital gains tax and capital acquisitions tax, which works out at close to 8 per cent a year. For VAT, employer PAYE, PRSI, USC, LPT and RCT the rate is 0.0274 per cent per day, close to 10 per cent a year. Both rates have applied since 1 July 2009 and are charged for each day or part of a day.

The surcharge is set by reference to how late the return is. Where the return is delivered within two months of the filing date, the surcharge is 5 per cent of the liability for the period, capped at EUR

12,695. Where it is delivered more than two months late, the surcharge is 10 per cent, capped at EUR 63,485.

The point most owner-managers miss is that for company directors the surcharge is calculated on the income tax liability for the period BEFORE any credit for tax deducted under PAYE, because section 1084(3) TCA 1997 disapplies the PAYE credit for directors. That is a far larger base than expected: a director on a substantial PAYE salary who files late is surcharged on the whole liability, not on the small balance remaining after PAYE. Where a couple is jointly assessed and the director spouse files late, the surcharge is computed without credit for PAYE deducted from either spouse's income. For a taxpayer who is not a director, the general rule applies instead: the surcharge is computed after credit for PAYE, but before credit for tax paid directly. It therefore applies in full even where the tax was paid on time. Paying early and filing late gives no protection at all. The surcharge is then treated as tax in its own right, so interest runs on the surcharge as well.

For companies there is a third consequence and it is often the largest. A late CT1 restricts the company's claims to loss relief, group relief and excess capital allowances, with the restriction scaled to the length of the delay. For a loss-making or group company this can cost considerably more than the surcharge itself.

A genuinely new business gets limited relief: the surcharge applies only from the second filing date of the business. That relief is withdrawn where the owner or promoter already has an existing business, or where their spouse or civil partner has one and the couple is jointly assessed.

Separately from Revenue, the company must file its annual return with the Companies Registration Office within 56 days of its annual return date. Where financial statements are attached, the deadline is the earlier of the annual return date plus 56 days and the financial year end plus nine months and 56 days. Late filing costs EUR 100 immediately plus EUR 3 for every further day, capped at EUR 1,200 per return, and the company loses its audit exemption for the following two financial years. For a small company, the cost of two years of audit fees usually dwarfs the filing penalty.

- Interest: 0.0219 per cent per day on income tax, corporation tax, CGT and CAT, roughly 8 per cent a year.
- Interest: 0.0274 per cent per day on VAT, employer PAYE, PRSI, USC, LPT and RCT, roughly 10 per cent a year.
- Surcharge within two months of the filing date: 5 per cent of the liability, capped at EUR 12,695.
- Surcharge more than two months late: 10 per cent of the liability, capped at EUR 63,485.
- Late CT1 also restricts loss relief, group relief and excess capital allowances in proportion to the delay.
- CRO annual return: 56 days after the annual return date. EUR 100 plus EUR 3 per day to a EUR 1,200 cap, plus loss of audit exemption for two years.

Key figures at a glance

Item	2026 position	Notes
Standard income tax pay and file deadline (2025 Form 11)	31 October 2026 (a Saturday)	Confirmed on Revenue's filing page and in eBrief 034/26.
ROS extended pay and file deadline 2026	Wednesday 18 November 2026	eBrief 034/26, published 16 February 2026. Requires the taxpayer to BOTH pay and file through ROS. Also covers CAT where the valuation date falls between 1 September 2025 and 31 August 2026.
Preliminary income tax option 1	90% of the current year liability	
Preliminary income tax option 2	100% of the prior year liability	The taxpayer pays the lowest of the three available options.
Preliminary income tax option 3	105% of the pre-preceding year liability	Direct debit payers only. Not available where the pre-preceding year liability was nil.
Proprietary director threshold	More than 15% of share capital	A proprietary director is a chargeable person and must file a Form 11.
CT1 filing deadline	9 months after the accounting period end, by the 21st of that month, or the 23rd on ROS	Where the accounting period ends before the 21st of a month, the return is due on the corresponding day nine months later. A 31 December 2025 year end gives 21 September 2026, or 23 September 2026 on ROS. Source: Revenue TDM Part 47-06-08 and the CT payment and filing page.
Small company threshold for preliminary corporation tax	EUR 200,000	Corporation tax liability of the previous accounting period, excluding surcharges and section 239 income tax. Confirmed. Above EUR 200,000 the company is large.
Small company preliminary CT due date	31 days before the accounting period end, and no later than the 23rd of that month	For a 31 December 2026 year end this gives 23 November 2026.
Small company preliminary CT amount	90% of current period or 100% of prior period	
Large company first instalment	45% of current period or 50% of prior period, by the 23rd of month 6	Revenue's page states the 23rd. The underlying statutory day is understood to be the 21st with the 23rd applying to ROS pay and file. Confirm before relying on the 23rd for a non-ROS filer.
Large company second instalment	Top up to 90% of the	Same 21st versus 23rd caveat as the first

Item	2026 position	Notes
	final liability, by the 23rd of month 11	instalment.
Large company, accounting period under 7 months	90% in a single instalment by the 23rd of month 6	
New company preliminary CT exemption	No preliminary tax for the first accounting period where CT is below EUR 200,000	
Corporation tax rates	12.5% trading, 25% passive	25% applies to excepted trades, rental and investment income. Matches the firm's held figure.
R&D corporation tax credit rate	35%	Budget 2026 raised the rate from 30% to 35% and the year one payable amount from EUR 75,000 to EUR 87,500. Matches the firm's held figure. However, Revenue's R&D landing page still described the 30% rate when checked on 29 July 2026, so confirm the exact commencement in Finance Act 2025 before advising a client.
Default VAT return period	Two months, starting 1 January, March, May, July, September, November	
VAT 3 return and payment deadline	19th of the following month, 23rd on ROS	
Four-monthly VAT filing threshold	Annual VAT liability EUR 3,001 to EUR 14,400	Subject to authorisation by the Collector-General.
Six-monthly VAT filing threshold	Annual VAT liability EUR 1 to EUR 3,000	Subject to authorisation by the Collector-General.
Return of Trading Details deadline	23rd of the month following the end of the accounting period	Taken from Revenue TDM VAT-RTD-S76 and the Revenue calendar of key dates. The TDM PDF would not parse cleanly on fetch, so read the source directly before quoting the date to a client. Non-filing can block tax clearance and VAT repayments.
Payroll submission timing	On or before the date the employee is paid	
Employer monthly statement created	By the 5th of the following month	

Item	2026 position	Notes
Employer statement deemed a return	14th of the following month	
Employer PAYE, PRSI, USC and LPT payment deadline	14th of the following month, 23rd on ROS	
CGT payment date, disposals 1 January to 30 November	15 December of the same year	This is 15 December, NOT 1 December. Revenue's calendar of key dates gives the same date for 2026.
CGT payment date, disposals in December	31 January of the following year	
CGT return deadline	31 October of the year following the disposal	Reported on the Form 11, or the Form CG1 where the individual is not otherwise a chargeable person.
CGT rate and annual exemption	33%, first EUR 1,270 of gains exempt	Matches the firm's held figures. The 33% rate has applied since 6 December 2012.
Revised entrepreneur relief lifetime limit	EUR 1.5 million	Increased from EUR 1 million by Budget 2026, for disposals of chargeable business assets on or after 1 January 2026.
Interest on late payment: income tax, corporation tax, CGT, CAT	0.0219% per day (about 8% per year)	In force since 1 July 2009. Charged for each day or part of a day. Statutory basis section 1080 TCA 1997.
Interest on late payment: VAT, employer PAYE/PRSI/USC/LPT, RCT	0.0274% per day (about 10% per year)	In force since 1 July 2009. Statutory basis section 991 TCA (employer), section 530Q TCA (RCT), section 114 VATCA 2010 (VAT).
Late return surcharge, filed within two months	5% of the liability, capped at EUR 12,695	Section 1084(2)(a) TCA 1997. Applies to income tax, corporation tax and CGT returns.
Late return surcharge, filed more than two months late	10% of the liability, capped at EUR 63,485	Section 1084(2)(b) TCA 1997. Calculated after credit for PAYE already paid but before credit for tax paid directly, so it applies even where the tax was paid on time.
CRO annual return deadline	56 days after the annual return date	Where financial statements are attached, the deadline is the earlier of the annual return date plus 56 days and the financial year end plus nine months and 56 days.
CRO late filing penalty	EUR 100 plus EUR 3 per day, capped at EUR 1,200 per return	The company also loses audit exemption for the following two years.
USC 2026 rates and bands	0.5% to EUR 12,012; 2% to EUR 28,700;	Matches the firm's held figures. The 2% band widened from EUR 27,382 in 2025 to

Item	2026 position	Notes
	3% to EUR 70,044; 8% on the balance	EUR 28,700 in 2026, and the 3% band narrowed correspondingly.
USC exemption threshold	EUR 13,000 total income	Matches the firm's held figure. Above EUR 13,000, USC is charged on the full income.
USC surcharge on non-PAYE income	3% on non-PAYE income above EUR 100,000	Matches the firm's held figure.
Income tax standard rate cut-off points 2026	EUR 44,000 single, EUR 53,000 married one income, plus up to EUR 35,000 for a second income	Budget 2026 made no changes to rates or bands. Matches the firm's held figures. Also EUR 48,000 for a single person qualifying for the single person child carer credit.
Main personal tax credits 2026	Personal EUR 2,000 single and EUR 4,000 married; Employee EUR 2,000; Earned Income EUR 2,000	Budget 2026 made no changes to tax credits. Matches the firm's held figures.
Self-employed PRSI (Class S) rate in 2026	4.2% to 30 September 2026, then 4.35% from 1 October 2026	The 4.2% rate took effect on 1 OCTOBER 2025, not at the start of 2026 as the firm's held note states. All PRSI rates rise by 0.15 percentage points on 1 October 2026. The gov.ie pages returned HTTP 403 on direct fetch, so this was taken from search extracts of the gov.ie Class S rates page and the 2026 Advance Notice. Verify directly before publication.

Before you rely on this

- **DISAGREEMENT WITH THE BRIEF, CGT payment date.** The brief states 1 December for January to November disposals. Revenue states 15 December. For disposals between 1 January and 30 November the tax is due by 15 December of that same year, confirmed on Revenue's CGT pay and file page and on Revenue's calendar of key dates for 2026. The 31 January date for December disposals is correct as stated.
- **DISAGREEMENT WITH THE FIRM'S HELD FIGURES, PRSI.** The firm's note says 4.1% in 2025 and 4.2% from the start of 2026. In fact the increase to 4.2% took effect on 1 October 2025, so 2025 was split between 4.1% and 4.2%. In 2026 the rate is 4.2% until 30 September and 4.35% from 1 October 2026. The 4.35% figure and the 1 October 2026 date in the firm's note are correct. This matters directly for any 90 per cent preliminary income tax estimate for 2026.
- **POSSIBLY STALE REVENUE PAGE, R&D credit.** The Revenue Budget 2026 Summary (published 7 October 2025) confirms the increase from 30% to 35%. However, Revenue's own R&D tax credit landing page still described the 30% rate when fetched on 29 July 2026. Confirm the commencement wording in Finance Act 2025 before quoting 35% to a client, particularly for a company with a non-

calendar accounting period.

- The ROS extension to 18 November 2026 is conditional on both paying AND filing through ROS. Doing only one loses the extension entirely and the deadline reverts to 31 October 2026. The same all-or-nothing logic applies to the 23rd-of-month ROS dates for VAT, PAYE and corporation tax. Where the taxpayer does not both file and pay by the extended date, Revenue computes interest from the original statutory due date plus one day.
- Large company preliminary corporation tax instalment dates. Revenue's web page states the 23rd of months six and eleven without distinguishing ROS from non-ROS filers. The underlying statutory day is understood to be the 21st, with the 23rd applying only to ROS pay and file. Check section 959AS TCA 1997 before advising a non-ROS filer.
- The Return of Trading Details due date of the 23rd of the month following the accounting period end comes from Revenue TDM VAT-RTD-S76 and Revenue's calendar of key dates. The TDM PDF did not parse cleanly when fetched, so a partner should read the source document directly before the memo is issued.
- The surcharge caps of EUR 12,695 and EUR 63,485 were confirmed against Revenue TDM Part 47-06-08, which shows a last-updated date of July 2025. The interest rates were confirmed against the Debt Management Services interest guidelines, last updated May 2025. Both should be re-checked for any revision issued since.
- 31 October 2026 falls on a Saturday. Revenue's published deadline is still 31 October, so anyone not using ROS should plan to be finished before the weekend.
- Not verified in this research: the age-banded pension relief scale of 15% to 40% and the EUR 115,000 earnings cap referenced in the firm's held figures. These were outside the scope of the deadline research and should be checked separately if the memo is to mention pension contributions made before the pay and file date.
- The enhanced reporting requirements are described here in outline only. The monetary limits for the small benefit exemption and the remote working daily allowance were not verified for 2026 and are deliberately not stated.

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<https://www.revenue.ie/en/tax-professionals/tdm/income-tax-capital-gains-tax-corporation-tax/part-47/47-06-08.pdf>

Revenue TDM, Guidelines for charging interest on late payment through Debt Management Services —

<https://www.revenue.ie/en/tax-professionals/tdm/collection/debt-management/guidelines-for-charging-interest-on-late-payment.pdf>

Revenue, When VAT becomes payable — <https://www.revenue.ie/en/vat/accounting-for-vat/how-to-account-for-value-added-tax/when-vat-becomes-payable.aspx>

Revenue TDM VAT-RTD-S76, VAT Return of Trading Details — <https://www.revenue.ie/en/tax-professionals/tdm/value-added-tax/part09-obligations-accountable-persons/return/VAT-RTD-S76.pdf>

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